

Raken Belayet

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EDUCATION

North-West University

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

Potchefstroom, South Africa

Feb. 2023 – Present

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Software Developer

Aizah Cafe

Feb. 2025

Stilfontein, South Africa

- Engineered a high-throughput desktop Point of Sale (POS) application using Java Swing to manage order entry, daily sales tracking, and inventory for 40–80 daily customer transactions.
- Architected a low-latency GUI optimized for high-speed checkout workflows during peak business hours, drastically reducing average order processing time.
- Designed lightweight data persistence pipelines using Java File I/O for reliable transaction logging, product catalog management, and session recovery without external database overhead.
- Implemented Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) and administrative authentication to restrict access to sensitive financial metrics, audit logs, and daily cash flow summaries.

Class Representative – CMPG111 (Intro to Programming)

North-West University

Feb. 2023 – Jun. 2023

Potchefstroom, South Africa

- Acted as the official technical liaison between a cohort of 200+ students and department faculty, facilitating course announcements and resolving academic feedback loops.
- Organized and led peer-to-peer study sessions to reinforce fundamental programming concepts, control structures, and algorithm logic.
- Collaborated with course instructors to optimize assignment distribution channels and clarify lab specifications.

PROJECTS

IP Conflicts (Game Jam 1st Place Winner) | *GameMaker, GML, Git*

May 2025

- Awarded 1st Place overall in the 48-hour Arcademia / NWU Game Jam for technical execution and game design.
- Architected multi-phase boss behaviors and enemy AI logic utilizing Finite State Machines (FSM) under strict 48-hour development constraints.
- Programmed custom pathfinding routines, target acquisition algorithms, and responsive hit-detection systems.

Productivity & Sobriety Tracker Mobile App | *React Native, TypeScript, Expo*

2024 – Present

- Built a cross-platform mobile application supporting custom daily goal tracking, metric units, and automated streak calculators.
- Leveraged React Native AsyncStorage to build an efficient, offline-first persistent storage system with automatic daily resets.
- Designed a responsive UI featuring custom gesture-driven swipe actions and dynamic progress visualizations.

Roadrunner Rentals System | *C#, .NET WinForms, SQL Server, GitHub*

Aug. 2024 – Sep. 2024

- Co-developed a C# WinForms application to automate vehicle leasing workflows, customer account management, and real-time fleet availability.
- Designed a normalized relational SQL database schema for reliable transactional operations across rentals, returns, and client profiles.
- Integrated user authentication, multi-parameter search queries, and dynamic analytical reporting views.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C#, C++, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL (MySQL, Oracle), HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Mobile: .NET, React Native, Expo, WinForms

Developer Tools: Git, GitHub, Visual Studio, VS Code, GameMaker, Unity

Core Concepts: OOP, Data Structures, Relational Database Design, REST APIs, Agile Workflow